

STRAWBERRY DREAM SET

JUMPER AND SKIRT · SIZES 44 TO 92

A matching two-piece set: a top-down jumper with a round yoke and long sleeves, and a separate skirt with a soft elasticated waist. Both pieces share the same leaf and seed pattern. Graded in nine sizes, from small newborn to two years.

44

small newborn / preemie

50

newborn, 0-1 mo

56

1-2 mo

62

2-4 mo

68

4-6 mo

74

6-9 mo

80

9-12 mo

86

12-18 mo

92

18-24 mo, 2 years

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Little Montessori Explorers

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Read the whole pattern before you start, and knit a gauge swatch. Mark your own size in the tables so you do not have to search as you go. Test knit version 1.0

BEFORE YOU START

The jumper is knitted top-down with a round yoke, long sleeves and a small buttoned opening at the back neck. The skirt is knitted separately, also from the top down, with a folded waistband that a soft elastic is threaded through at the end. The two pieces share the charts, the gauge and the colours, but are knitted entirely independently.

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- knitting a jumper with a round yoke
- dividing for body and sleeves, and working sleeves in the round
- knitting a skirt with a folded, elasticated waistband
- adjusting the length and finishing with a picot edge

DIFFICULTY

Easy to slightly experienced. The sleeves are the only part with few stitches on the needle, and there Magic Loop or double-pointed needles help.

SIZES

The pattern is graded in nine sizes, from 44 to 92, that is from small newborn to two years. Choose by the child's chest measurement, not by age. The ages are only a guide, and a baby born early follows its own curve. Between two sizes, take the larger one, since a garment that is slightly big lasts longer.

THE CHILD'S MEASUREMENTS

Size	Suits	Child chest	Ease
44	small newborn / preemie	32 cm	6,1 cm
50	newborn, 0-1 mo	35 cm	6,9 cm
56	1-2 mo	38 cm	5,8 cm
62	2-4 mo	41 cm	6,6 cm
68	4-6 mo	43 cm	6,5 cm
74	6-9 mo	45 cm	6,4 cm
80	9-12 mo	47 cm	6,3 cm
86	12-18 mo	49 cm	6,2 cm
92	18-24 mo, 2 years	51 cm	6,1 cm

HOW TO READ THE TABLES

Every number in the pattern is given in its own column per size. Find your column once, mark it with a pen, and read only that one from there on.

FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

Size	Jumper chest	Jumper length	Sleeve length	Skirt waist	Skirt length
44	40,0 cm	23 cm	14 cm	34,3 cm	19 cm
50	43,8 cm	25 cm	16 cm	38,1 cm	21 cm
56	45,7 cm	27 cm	18 cm	41,9 cm	23 cm
62	49,5 cm	29 cm	20 cm	45,7 cm	25 cm
68	51,4 cm	31 cm	21 cm	49,5 cm	27 cm
74	53,3 cm	32 cm	22 cm	53,3 cm	29 cm
80	55,2 cm	34 cm	23 cm	57,1 cm	31 cm
86	57,1 cm	35 cm	24 cm	61,0 cm	33 cm
92	59,0 cm	36 cm	25 cm	64,8 cm	35 cm

The measurements below are the garment as it should be after washing and drying flat. If you get different measurements, it is usually the gauge and not the pattern.

YARN, TOOLS AND GAUGE

YARN AND NEEDLES

DROPS Merino Extra Fine, 50 g = approx. 105 m, in strawberry pink, leaf green and a small amount of cream white. The amounts below include a good margin, and are given per size.

Tools	For what
4 mm needles	double-pointed or Magic Loop for neck, sleeves and waistband
1 flat button	approx. 10-12 mm, for the jumper back neck opening
Soft elastic	approx. 1 cm wide, for the skirt waistband
Darning needle	for weaving in ends and sewing down the waistband and picot
Stitch marker	to mark the beginning of the round and each sleeve side

YARN AMOUNT

Size	Pink	Green	Cream
44	705 g	65 g	5 g
50	870 g	70 g	5 g
56	1030 g	75 g	5 g
62	1230 g	85 g	5 g
68	1410 g	90 g	5 g
74	1600 g	95 g	5 g
80	1800 g	95 g	5 g
86	2020 g	100 g	5 g
92	2245 g	105 g	5 g

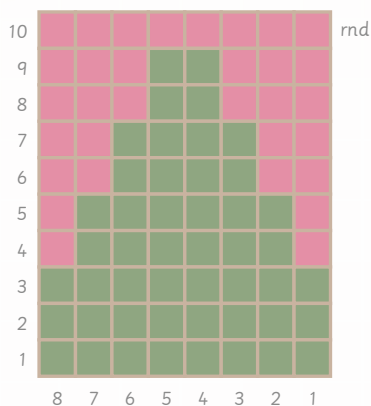
GAUGE

21 stitches and 28 rounds in stocking stitch = 10 x 10 cm on 4 mm needles. Knit your swatch in the round, not flat, and measure it after washing and drying flat. More than 21 stitches means one needle size up, fewer means one down. The gauge decides every measurement here.

LEAF AND SEED CHARTS

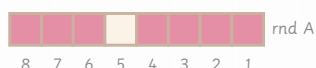
Both charts are read from the bottom up, and each round from right to left, the same way you knit. The leaf repeat is 8 stitches and is repeated all the way round the yoke. The number of repeats for your size is given further on.

LEAF, 8 STITCHES x 10 ROUNDS

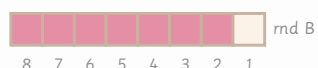


SEED, 8 STITCHES

A



B



The seeds are single cream white stitches scattered over the pink. Work round A, then 2-3 rounds in pink, then round B. Repeat as densely or as sparsely as you like.

The float behind the work is never longer than 3 stitches in either chart. That is deliberate: long loose strands on the inside are both uncomfortable against the skin and something small fingers can catch in. Keep the carried yarn loose enough that the work does not pucker.

JUMPER · 1 · NECK AND YOKE

Cast on in green on 4 mm needles and work 5 rows of twisted rib back and forth. On row 3 make one buttonhole 3 stitches in from the edge: knit 2 together, yarn over. Continue in stocking stitch back and forth. Divide the stitches into 8 equal sections and increase 1 stitch in each section every other row, that is 8 stitches per increase round. When the back opening measures approx. 4 cm, cast on 2 stitches over the opening and join to work in the round. Continue the increases until you have the stitch count in your column, work the even rounds in the last column, then the leaf repeat from page 5 over 8 stitches. Finish with 1 round in pink.

Size	Cast on	Per section	Inc. rnds	Even rnds	Yoke	Leaf rep.
44	48 sts	6	8	1	112 sts	14 x
50	48 sts	6	10	1	128 sts	16 x
56	56 sts	7	10	3	136 sts	17 x
62	56 sts	7	12	1	152 sts	19 x
68	56 sts	7	13	1	160 sts	20 x
74	64 sts	8	13	2	168 sts	21 x
80	64 sts	8	14	2	176 sts	22 x
86	64 sts	8	15	1	184 sts	23 x
92	72 sts	9	15	2	192 sts	24 x

The buttoned back opening is not decoration, it is necessary. A neck wide enough to pass over the head without an opening would hang loose around the neck afterwards, and that holds in every size. With the opening the neck can sit where it should.

JUMPER · 2 · DIVIDE FOR BODY AND SLEEVES

Read the row for your size from left to right, in the order you knit: the front, the stitches you place on hold for the first sleeve, the stitches you cast on under the arm, the back, then the same sleeve on the other side. The jumper casts on 4 stitches under each arm, two more than the dress and the romper, because a sleeve needs a little extra width at the underarm.

Size	Front	Hold for sleeve	Cast on	Back	Body
44	38	18	4	38	84 sts
50	42	22	4	42	92 sts
56	44	24	4	44	96 sts
62	48	28	4	48	104 sts
68	50	30	4	50	108 sts
74	52	32	4	52	112 sts
80	54	34	4	54	116 sts
86	56	36	4	56	120 sts
92	58	38	4	58	124 sts

JUMPER · 3 · THE BODY

Work in pink stocking stitch in the round with seeds: seed round A, 2-3 rounds in pink, then seed round B. Repeat as densely or sparsely as you like. Work until the body measures the length in your column, measured straight down from the underarm. Change to green, work 6 rounds of twisted rib and cast off with stretch.

Size	Body stitches	Chest	Length from underarm	Rounds of rib
44	84 sts	40,0 cm	11 cm	6
50	92 sts	43,8 cm	12 cm	6
56	96 sts	45,7 cm	13 cm	6
62	104 sts	49,5 cm	14 cm	6
68	108 sts	51,4 cm	15 cm	6
74	112 sts	53,3 cm	16 cm	6
80	116 sts	55,2 cm	17 cm	6
86	120 sts	57,1 cm	18 cm	6
92	124 sts	59,0 cm	19 cm	6

Always cast off loosely in rib. A tight cast-off stops the jumper from pulling down over the chest, and that shows most in the smallest sizes.

JUMPER · 4 · THE SLEEVES

Place the held sleeve stitches on the needle and pick up the stitches under the arm. Place a marker at the centre of the underarm. Work in pink stocking stitch in the round, with a few seeds spaced well apart. Decrease 1 stitch at each side of the marker, that is 2 stitches per decrease round, spread evenly over the length of the sleeve. The number of decrease rounds is given in your column.

Size	Held stitches	Pick up	Upper arm	Decrease rounds	Cuff	Sleeve length
44	18	4	22 sts	3	16 sts	14 cm
50	22	4	26 sts	4	18 sts	16 cm
56	24	4	28 sts	4	20 sts	18 cm
62	28	4	32 sts	5	22 sts	20 cm
68	30	4	34 sts	5	24 sts	21 cm
74	32	4	36 sts	5	26 sts	22 cm
80	34	4	38 sts	5	28 sts	23 cm
86	36	4	40 sts	5	30 sts	24 cm
92	38	4	42 sts	5	32 sts	25 cm

THE CUFF

When the sleeve measures approx. 2 cm less than the sleeve length in the table, change to green and work 6 rounds of twisted rib. Cast off with stretch. Work the second sleeve exactly the same.

SKIRT · 5 · THE WAISTBAND

Cast on loosely in green and join in the round. The stitch count already divides by 8, so the leaf repeat comes out even without adjustment. Work 2.5 cm in stocking stitch, 1 purl round for the fold line, then another 2.5 cm in stocking stitch. Place the cast-on edge on a spare needle and knit one stitch from each needle together all the way round, leaving an opening of approx. 2 cm for the elastic.

Size	Cast on	Leaf repeats	Waist	Waistband height
44	72 sts	9 x	34,3 cm	2 x 2,5 cm
50	80 sts	10 x	38,1 cm	2 x 2,5 cm
56	88 sts	11 x	41,9 cm	2 x 2,5 cm
62	96 sts	12 x	45,7 cm	2 x 2,5 cm
68	104 sts	13 x	49,5 cm	2 x 2,5 cm
74	112 sts	14 x	53,3 cm	2 x 2,5 cm
80	120 sts	15 x	57,1 cm	2 x 2,5 cm
86	128 sts	16 x	61,0 cm	2 x 2,5 cm
92	136 sts	17 x	64,8 cm	2 x 2,5 cm

Cast on loosely. The waistband must stretch over the hips, and a tight cast-on edge is the most common reason a baby skirt will not go on.

SKIRT · 6 · LEAVES, WIDTH AND LENGTH

Work the leaf repeat from page 5 over 8 stitches, repeated as many times as your column says. Then change to pink and work *k2, M1*, repeat round. The skirt is now at full width. Continue in pink stocking stitch with scattered seeds until the skirt measures the length in the last column, measured below the waistband.

Size	Waistband stitches	Leaf repeats	*k2, M1* gives	Skirt width	Length from waistband
44	72 sts	9 x	108 sts	51,4 cm	16 cm
50	80 sts	10 x	120 sts	57,1 cm	18 cm
56	88 sts	11 x	132 sts	62,9 cm	20 cm
62	96 sts	12 x	144 sts	68,6 cm	22 cm
68	104 sts	13 x	156 sts	74,3 cm	24 cm
74	112 sts	14 x	168 sts	80,0 cm	26 cm
80	120 sts	15 x	180 sts	85,7 cm	28 cm
86	128 sts	16 x	192 sts	91,4 cm	30 cm
92	136 sts	17 x	204 sts	97,1 cm	32 cm

The leaves on the skirt point downwards, just as on the jumper yoke, so the two pieces match when worn together.

SKIRT · 7 · PICOT EDGE AND ELASTIC

THE PICOT EDGE

Work 3 rounds in pink, then an eyelet round: *yarn over, k2tog*, repeat round. Work 3 more rounds and cast off loosely. Fold the edge to the inside along the eyelet round and sew it down loosely on the wrong side.

THE ELASTIC

Measure the baby's waist and cut a soft elastic 1 cm shorter than the measurement. Thread it through the waistband with a safety pin, sew the ends firmly together with several rows of stitches, then close the opening in the waistband. The elastic should hold the skirt up without marking the skin. Check with a finger: you should slip easily under the waistband.

On the smallest children the skin is especially delicate. If in doubt, choose the looser elastic and tighten it later if needed.

FOR YOU, THE TEST KNITTER

This edition of the set is a test knit version. Every stitch count has been calculated from the babies' measurements and the gauge, and checked against the others, but nobody has knitted from the pattern yet. You are the first. That means you may run into things I have not seen, and that is exactly why I need you.

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

- Which size you knitted, and which yarn and needles you used.
- Your own gauge, measured on a washed swatch dried flat.
- The finished measurements of the garment after washing, in the form below.
- Anything unclear: a sentence you had to read three times, a stitch count that did not add up, a place where you had to guess.
- A photo of the finished garment, on the baby if you like.
- Tell me if the pattern reminds you of one you have seen before. Strawberry Dream is drawn for LME, and I want to know straight away if something still sits too close to something else.

MEASUREMENT FORM, FILL IN AFTER WASHING

Size knitted

My gauge, stitches per 10 cm

My gauge, rounds per 10 cm

Yarn and needles

Chest after washing

Total length after washing

Time taken, roughly

Yarn used, grams

HOW TO SEND IT IN

Send the form, your comments and any photos to <https://lmexplorers.com/teststrikk>. The deadline is given in the email the pattern came in.

Nothing is too small to mention. Whatever tripped you up will trip up the next knitter too, and it is far easier to fix now than later.

FINISHING AND AFTERCARE

CHECKLIST

- Weave in all ends flat and firmly on the wrong side. Do not cut them flush.
- Soak the work in lukewarm water with wool detergent. Do not rub or wring.
- Press the water out in a towel and dry the garment flat to the given measurements.
- Check all buttons, ties, edges and loose ends before the garment is worn.
- Check that the elastic sits softly and leaves no marks after an hour of wear.
- Measure the garment after washing and write the numbers in the form on the previous page.

SAFETY

Buttons and ties on children's garments must always be checked before use, and the garment worn only under supervision. Sew buttons on with strong thread and go over them again after every wash. In the smallest sizes the garment sits right against the skin, so feel that no seam or knot presses hard.

Happy knitting!

STRAWBERRY DREAM

THE WHOLE COLLECTION

- Strawberry Dream dress, sleeveless with a leaf yoke and a flared skirt.
- Strawberry Dream romper with skirt, with a nappy panel and buttons at the crotch.
- Strawberry Dream jumper and skirt, a two-piece set with an elasticated waist.
- Strawberry Dream mittens, thumbless, with a connecting cord, sizes 44 to 74.
- Strawberry Dream booties, with a folded rib cuff and ties at the ankle, sizes 44 to 92.

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